

and use the flash. This works on many levels, making sure that the flash is not blinding and giving the face a more natural, flat appearance, instead of a bulbous one, when the subject is close to the camera.

The night-time is also the best time to capture streaks of light. This can range from a line of traffic to fireworks or a meteor shower. For all such cases, keep a very high ISO setting, the camera on a stable surface or a tripod. Invest in a clicker, which stops the camera from shaking when you click the photograph, and makes it easier to hold the clicker pressed if you are using a custom ISO setting.

If your photograph has not come out great, don't lose hope. You can always recover detail by digital manipulation. Increasing the brightness and contrast usually does the trick. You may also have to correct the colours a bit, because photos taken at night tend to have a greenish or bluish hue.

5.6 Action

When it comes to action shots, a high ISO is absolutely essential. This means that the object is not blurred when the shot is taken. Also, you will have to use a zoom lens so that you do not interrupt the action. Track the movement with your camera before taking the shot, and while clicking. This makes the background blurry, but in the direction of the movement, accentuating the movement of the object.

Experiment with angles here, tilting in the direction of the motion will also help depict the movement better. The essence of the image here is to capture the action. If your zoom permits it, capturing the expressions of the people during concentration makes for great, and sometimes funny photographs. If all your camera permits is a wide shot of the entire ground, or you are positioned very far away from the action, look for other interesting subjects in the foreground (say, an interesting spectator) and make the action itself the background.

When capturing kids or pets in movement, take a series of photographs, using the burst mode at times. You can delete the ones you don't want later on, but this increases your chances of getting a good shot. Position yourself in such a way that you are not intruding in on the action, and use zoom where necessary.